



TV shows for lockdown

While there are many lists of TV shows to binge on, this one has a recommendation for every mood. <https://digit.in/apr20-51>



Angry Birds TV show

Netflix has ordered an Angry Birds: Summer Madness animated TV show slotted for a 2021 release. <https://digit.in/apr20-52>



STORYTELLING THROUGH MUSIC

The soundtrack of a series can help push the narrative further while extensively enhancing viewer experience

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ou are sitting on your couch, watching a horror or thriller show like *Stranger Things* and an ominous track

starts. You know something bad is about to happen. The soundtrack says it all. We don't always pay attention to it, but it can make or break a scene. Music score can add to or detract from your viewing experience. The right tracks, when added to your favorite shows, can be such a value add.

For years, music supervisors have worked relentlessly to create iconic moments in your favorite series, be it in a

scene or the title track. But it was only in 2017 that this job got mainstream recognition when an Emmy award category for it was created - Outstanding Music Supervision. And the first one was taken home by Susan Jacobs for her work on the hit show *Big Little Lies*.

ORIGINAL SOUND TRACKS - MAKERS OR BREAKERS?

There's a long list of memorable shows featuring original soundtracks. A good sound track could make a mediocre show come to life while a bad soundtrack for a good show could have disastrous effects. A soundtrack can feature in various ways in a show - in the title track, specific to a character, setting up a scene etc. They can

be as popular as the series itself - tracks from *Friends* and *Fresh Prince of Bel-Air* are prime examples.

CHARACTER DEVELOPMENT THROUGH MUSIC

While Ramin Djawadi had already gained popularity with his compositions for the 2008 Marvel hit *Iron Man*, his work on the iconic theme track for the superhit series *Game of Thrones* made him a household name. Djawadi created different themes for the houses while some characters got modified versions of these house themes. Arya Stark was the first of the Stark house to get her own theme while Daenerys had a rather small cello theme in the beginning which grew to become more powerful as her character gained importance and power in the show.

When Josh Schwartz created his super-hit series *The O.C.*, he wanted the music to be a character on the show. And this was exactly what he managed to do with his four-season long coming-of-age series in the mid 2000s. The original sound track of the show played the emotional guide that helped viewers find their way through a myriad of challenging themes. Everything from social ostracization to the perils of addiction were shown using music. The show was a true champion in bringing a number of indie rock bands to the forefront. *Death Cab for Cutie*, *Nada Surf*, *Beck* and other such artists may have never gotten such a populated viewer platform, had it not been for *The O.C.*

STAYING ALIVE THROUGH THE SOUNDTRACK

While there were popular themes and songs that added flavour to a series, there were also those who helped make the show popular beyond the realm of TV. The soundtrack of *The Fresh Prince of Bel-Air* starring Will Smith had a number of cover versions and spoofs continuing to make appearances decades after the show had completed its run. An acoustic version of the theme track 'Yo Home To Bel-Air' was performed by Ed Sheeran at Capital FM as recently as January